



CITY OF MEDFORD
AFFORDABLE HOUSING TRUST FUND BOARD

85 George P. Hassett Drive, Medford MA 02155
(781) 393-2480 | kbuckingham@medford-ma.gov

February 11, 2026

RE: Inclusionary Fractional Payment Ordinance

Dear City Councilors,

On behalf of the Medford Affordable Housing Trust Fund Board, I am writing to express enthusiastic support for an ordinance that would allow the City of Medford to accept fractional payments to be paid in lieu of rounding up the number of affordable units created.

This past fall, Councilor Leming presented Resolution 25-136 to the Board, supporting a fractional payment ordinance and calling on the Affordable Housing Trust Fund Board to make recommendations on how to update this policy. In subsequent months, the Board was given frequent updates from city staff members and provided feedback regarding specific language for this ordinance. The Board unanimously voted to voice our approval of this ordinance, as included below.

This change has the potential to increase the amount of housing constructed by reducing the incentive for developers to limit the size of their developments in order to avoid rounding up the number of affordable units they are required to provide. Furthermore, the revenue from fractional payments would be a valuable funding source to the Affordable Housing Trust Fund, allowing future investment in supporting affordable housing in Medford.

We respectfully encourage members of the City Council to support this important initiative and thank you for your steadfast commitment to enhancing affordable housing opportunities in Medford.

Sincerely,

Digitally signed by Lisa Davidson
DN: cn=Lisa Davidson, o, ou,
email=lisaannedavidson@gmail.com, c=US
Date: 2026.02.12 12:51:22 -05'00'

Lisa Davidson, Chair of the Medford Affordable Housing Trust Fund Board

Fractional Payment Suggested Language:

1. ***Fractional units.*** Where the required number of affordable units results in a fraction of a unit, at the election of the applicant for development, either (a) the required number of affordable units shall be rounded up to the nearest whole number, or (b) the applicant shall make a fractional cash payment to Medford's Affordable Housing Trust Fund. The fractional cash payment shall be equal to the fraction of the unit multiplied by the equivalent value of an affordable unit. The equivalent value of the affordable unit shall be based on the then-applicable Total Development Cost as articulated in the EOHLC Qualified Allocation Plan for Low Income Housing Tax Credits, for the areas described as Within Metro Boston/Urban Area (as adjusted for the type of project and number of units). This value shall be reviewed and confirmed by staff of the office of community development. The applicant shall make their election prior to submitting a site plan review application by notifying the office of community development in writing. The payment to the Medford Affordable Housing Trust Fund shall be calculated at the time of the building permit application and due prior to the issuance of the building permit or as agreed to in a fee payment agreement.